

NOSTALGIC

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Summary

Nostalgics preserve the equipment, techniques, customs, and practical knowledge of earlier eras by continuing to use them.

Some restore weapons whose designs predate the **Star Dream**. Others reproduce traditional clothing, practice historical crafts, study obsolete machinery, cook from handwritten recipes, navigate from physical charts, or maintain customs that have survived only in archives and museums.

A nostalgic can appreciate modern technology perfectly well. Their expertise lies in understanding older things deeply enough to keep them useful.

The infosphere makes historical information easy to retrieve. Practical knowledge is harder to preserve. A technical diagram can explain how a black-powder firearm was assembled without teaching someone how it feels when the mechanism is beginning to foul. A museum archive can preserve a dead language without preserving the gestures, jokes, etiquette, and habits that once accompanied it.

Nostalgics learn those missing details.

The archetype is most commonly associated with equipment carrying the **archaic** trait, though many of its abilities also cover old languages, customs, ruins, historical technologies, and other remnants of earlier eras.

NOSTALGIC MODIFICATIONS

A **nostalgic modification** is an archaic item restored and adapted using modern materials and precision while preserving its original construction and operating principles.

A nostalgic-modified item retains the **archaic** trait. It doesn't automatically gain the analog or tech trait.

Visible modifications vary by item. An old firearm might use precisely manufactured replacement springs, improved metallurgy, modern propellant produced to an obsolete specification, or concealed reinforcement in its frame. A sword might use a historically accurate blade geometry produced with modern material tolerances. A bow might use improved laminates hidden beneath traditional finishing.

WEAPON GRADES

A nostalgic-modified archaic weapon can use the normal Starfinder weapon improvement system.

Grade	Level	Upgrade Price	Total Grade Value	Upgrade Slots	Damage Dice	Tracking
Commercial	0	—	—	0	1	—
Tactical	2	350 credits	350 credits	0	1	+1
Advanced	4	650 credits	1,000 credits	1	2	+1
Superior	10	9,000 credits	10,000 credits	1	2	+2
Elite	12	10,000 credits	20,000 credits	2	3	+2
Ultimate	16	80,000 credits	100,000 credits	2	3	+3
Paragon	19	300,000 credits	400,000 credits	3	4	+3

The price of the original archaic weapon is separate from the cost of its grade improvements.

A nostalgic-modified weapon can accept weapon upgrades even though it lacks the analog or tech trait. A tech upgrade remains a tech item after installation without giving the weapon itself the tech trait.

RUNES AND GRADES

Fundamental and property weapon runes become dormant while a weapon uses nostalgic modifications. Their effects return if the nostalgic modifications are removed.

The **Runic Preservation** feat allows property runes to function alongside the Starfinder improvement system.

OPTIONAL ARCHAIC EQUIPMENT RULES

If the campaign uses the optional archaic equipment rules, a nostalgic-modified weapon you wield uses its normal damage die against non-archaic armor.

Its Broken Threshold is also calculated normally.

These benefits do nothing in a campaign where the optional archaic equipment rules aren't being used.

ARCHAIC WEAPONS AND CLASS ABILITIES

For you, an archaic firearm counts as a **gun** when determining whether you can use an ability that requires a gun. The weapon retains the archaic trait and doesn't gain the analog or tech trait.

You can use **Aim** with any archaic ranged weapon. An archaic ranged weapon also counts as a gun for an ability that includes Aim as part of its effect.

Other abilities requiring a gun use an archaic firearm unless another Nostalgic feat says otherwise.

NOSTALGIC FEATS

NOSTALGIC DEDICATION

FEAT 2

UNCOMMON ARCHETYPE DEDICATION

Prerequisites trained in Crafting or Society

You have spent enough time studying earlier eras to reproduce their equipment and practices with more than academic accuracy.

You gain **Additional Lore** for History Lore. If you already have Additional Lore for History Lore, choose another Lore skill associated with a historical period, culture, technology, or tradition.

You gain access to common equipment with the archaic trait.

You can apply **nostalgic modifications** to archaic weapons. You can improve these weapons using the normal Starfinder weapon-grade progression. You must meet the normal level and cost requirements for improving equipment.

While you wield a nostalgic-modified archaic weapon, its Broken Threshold is calculated normally, and it doesn't reduce its damage die against non-archaic armor if the campaign uses the optional archaic equipment rules.

An archaic firearm counts as a gun for your abilities. You can use Aim with any archaic ranged weapon, and an archaic ranged weapon counts as a gun for abilities that include Aim as part of their effect.

Special You can't select another dedication feat until you've gained two other feats from the Nostalgic archetype.

ADDITIONAL FEATS

The following existing feats can be selected as Nostalgic archetype feats at the listed levels.

When you gain one of these feats through the Nostalgic archetype, any weapon you use to perform the feat must have the archaic trait. An archaic ranged weapon satisfies a requirement for a gun when the feat includes Aim. Other gun requirements require an archaic firearm.

These feats count as Nostalgic feats for the purpose of completing Nostalgic Dedication.

Level	Feat	Original Source
4	Quick Draw	Pathfinder
4	Assisting Shot	Pathfinder
4	Dueling Parry	Pathfinder
4	Instinctive Aim	Starfinder Operative
4	Mobile Aim	Starfinder Operative
4	Ready Reload	Starfinder Soldier
4	Whirling Swipe	Starfinder Soldier
6	Running Reload	Pathfinder

Level	Feat	Original Source
8	Dueling Riposte	Pathfinder
8	Spellsurge Ammo*	Starfinder Witchwarper
10	Delay Trap	Pathfinder
12	Deflecting Shot	Pathfinder
14	Dueling Dance	Pathfinder

*When you gain Spellsurge Ammo through this archetype, you must be able to Cast a Spell, and its weapon benefit applies only to an archaic weapon.

FIELD ANTIQUARIAN

FEAT 4

ARCHETYPE SKILL

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

Years spent handling actual historical objects have taught you details that rarely survive in databases.

You can use History Lore to Recall Knowledge about archaic equipment, historical technology, ruins, obsolete machinery, and artifacts regardless of the skill normally required.

When you can physically examine the subject of the check, you gain a +1 circumstance bonus to the check.

PERIOD AUTHENTICITY

FEAT 4

ARCHETYPE SKILL

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

You understand how historical customs were practiced in daily life.

When reproducing a historical performance, ceremony, disguise, profession, or social custom, you can use History Lore in place of Performance or Society.

You can also use History Lore in place of Deception to Impersonate a person from a historical culture or profession, provided your disguise and behavior are appropriate to what you're portraying.

RELIABLE REPRODUCTION

FEAT 6

ARCHETYPE SKILL

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication, expert in Crafting

You can manufacture the expendable pieces that keep obsolete equipment usable.

You don't need a formula to Craft common level-0 archaic ammunition or mundane replacement parts for archaic equipment.

When Crafting such items, you can complete your initial preparation in 1 hour instead of the normal minimum preparation time. All other Crafting costs and requirements remain unchanged.

RESTORED PROTECTION

FEAT 6

ARCHETYPE

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

You can apply nostalgic modifications to archaic armor.

Nostalgic-modified archaic armor can be improved using the normal Starfinder armor-grade progression and can accept armor upgrades. It retains the archaic and exposed traits and doesn't gain environmental protections simply from being improved.

Fundamental and property armor runes become dormant while the armor uses nostalgic modifications.

If the campaign uses the optional archaic equipment rules, nostalgic-modified armor you wear doesn't gain a weakness to non-archaic weapons, and its Broken Threshold is calculated normally.

Archaic shields you maintain also use their normal Broken Threshold under the optional archaic equipment rules.

OLD-SCHOOL SOLUTION

FEAT 6

ARCHETYPE SKILL

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication, expert in Crafting

You have a habit of solving sophisticated problems by finding the mechanical system underneath them.

When a technological device has accessible physical controls, moving components, wiring, relays, locks, or other hardware, you can use Crafting in place of Computers to Operate the Device.

You can also use Crafting in place of Computers or Thievery to Disable a Device when the obstacle can reasonably be defeated through physical alteration or mechanical interference.

You can't use this feat to Hack, Program, remotely access a system, decrypt information, or perform an action that depends entirely on software.

TRAP SPOTTER

FEAT 6

ARCHETYPE SKILL

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication, expert in Perception

You recognize the construction habits that give away concealed defenses.

Whenever you come within 10 feet of a trap, security device, or hazard whose minimum proficiency rank to detect is expert or lower, the GM rolls a secret Perception check for you to notice it.

At 12th level, you can detect hazards requiring master proficiency in this way. At 18th level, you can detect hazards requiring legendary proficiency.

MASTER TRANSLATOR

FEAT 8

ARCHETYPE SKILL

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication, master in Society or History Lore

Exposure to dead languages, obsolete notation, damaged inscriptions, and incomplete archives has made unfamiliar writing easier for you to approach.

You can use History Lore when you Decipher Writing regardless of the subject or language involved.

If the writing belongs to a historical or otherwise archaic language, a critical failure on your check becomes a failure.

After spending at least 10 minutes examining examples of a previously unknown written language, you can attempt to Decipher Writing from that language even if you have no existing linguistic reference for it.

CRITICAL TRADITION

FEAT 8

ARCHETYPE

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

You know what your weapon was designed to do when a blow lands perfectly.
You gain access to the critical specialization effects of archaic weapons you wield.

UNFASHIONABLY RELIABLE

FEAT 8**ARCHETYPE**

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

Frequency once per hour

Trigger An archaic weapon or shield you're wielding would become broken because of a misfire, critical failure, or other malfunction caused by your use of the item.

You recognize the failure as it begins and compensate before the mechanism gives way.

The item doesn't become broken from the triggering effect. If the effect created a misfire or similar malfunction that must normally be cleared before the item can be used again, you can immediately Interact to clear it as part of this reaction.

RUNIC PRESERVATION

FEAT 8**ARCHETYPE**

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

You have learned to preserve old magical workmanship while incorporating modern improvements.

A property rune can function on a nostalgic-modified weapon or suit of armor. Each functioning property rune occupies one of the item's upgrade slots and counts as an upgrade for the purpose of determining how many modifications the item can support.

Fundamental runes remain dormant.

For prerequisites involving a fundamental weapon rune, use the item's tracking bonus and number of weapon damage dice as the equivalent progression. For prerequisites involving a fundamental armor rune, use the armor's grade and resilient value.

The GM determines equivalencies for a property rune whose prerequisite doesn't have a direct Starfinder counterpart.

SHOW THEM HOW IT WAS DONE

FEAT 8**ARCHETYPE****VISUAL**

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

Frequency once per round

Trigger You critically succeed at a Strike with an archaic weapon.

Your success gives an ally a clear demonstration of the technique.

Choose one ally within 30 feet who can see you. That ally gains a +1 circumstance bonus to their next attack roll against the creature you critically hit before the start of your next turn.

MEASURED SHOT

FEAT 10**ARCHETYPE****CONCENTRATE**

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

Requirements You're wielding an archaic ranged weapon.

You take the extra moment older weapons reward.

Make a ranged Strike with the required weapon. You gain a +2 circumstance bonus to the attack roll and ignore the target's concealed condition for this Strike.

If the target is hidden from you, reduce the flat check to target it from DC 11 to DC 5 for this Strike.

OLD WORDS, NEW POWER

FEAT 10

ARCHETYPE

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication, ability to Cast a Spell

Frequency once per round

Trigger You Cast a Spell that isn't a cantrip.

The familiar motions surrounding your equipment have become part of your spellcasting rhythm.

Interact to draw an archaic weapon, reload an archaic weapon by 1 action's worth of its reload requirement, or Switch Hands with an archaic weapon.

LIVING ANACHRONISM

FEAT 10

ARCHETYPE

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

You've learned enough modern fighting doctrine to translate techniques developed for contemporary weapons back onto older designs.

When an ability you possess requires you to wield an analog weapon, tech weapon, or gun, a nostalgic-modified archaic weapon can satisfy that requirement when its physical form is capable of performing the action.

This doesn't grant the weapon the analog or tech trait, and it can't make an item perform something its construction can't support. A sword can't expend ammunition, a bow can't produce a muzzle flash, and a single-shot firearm can't fire ammunition that hasn't been loaded into it.

The GM determines unusual interactions.

ARCHAEOLOGICAL REVELATION

FEAT 12

ARCHETYPE SKILL

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication, master in History Lore

Frequency once per day

Discovering something genuinely new reminds you why you spend so much time looking backward.

When you spend at least 10 minutes examining and documenting a significant artifact, ruin, machine, text, or cultural practice you had never previously encountered, you gain 1 Hero Point.

You can't increase your Hero Points above the normal maximum in this way.

The discovery must contain meaningful information that was previously unknown to you. The GM determines whether a discovery is significant enough to trigger this feat.

LIVING CURRICULUM

FEAT 12

ARCHETYPE

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

You continually revisit old fighting manuals, field journals, reconstructed demonstrations, and surviving practical traditions.

During your daily preparations, choose one feat from the Nostalgic archetype's Additional Feats list of 8th level or lower. You must meet its prerequisites.

You gain that feat until your next daily preparations.

A temporary feat gained this way can't be used to satisfy the prerequisites of another feat.

THEY DON'T MAKE THEM LIKE THEY USED TO

FEAT 14

ARCHETYPE

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

The features modern designers considered obsolete are sometimes exactly what you want.

The first time each round that you critically hit with a nostalgic-modified archaic weapon, roll one additional weapon damage die and add it to the damage after doubling the Strike's normal damage.

Use the weapon's normal damage die before any increase from the fatal trait. This additional die isn't doubled.

PERIOD SPECIALIST

FEAT 14

ARCHETYPE SKILL

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

Choose a historical culture, technological era, artistic tradition, military tradition, or similar period of study.

You gain Additional Lore for a Lore skill representing that specialty.

When you Recall Knowledge about your specialty and roll a failure, you still learn one piece of accurate basic information, though you don't gain any additional information that would normally come from a successful check.

Once per hour, when you critically fail a Recall Knowledge check concerning your specialty, you get a failure instead.

IMPOSSIBLE RESTORATION

FEAT 16

ARCHETYPE SKILL

Prerequisites Master Restorer, legendary in Crafting

Scrap, corrosion, missing components, and centuries of neglect rarely make an object completely unrecoverable to you.

You can restore a destroyed archaic item when at least one-quarter of the original object remains and enough evidence survives to determine its original construction.

Reconstruction requires downtime and suitable materials determined by the GM. Missing ordinary components can be recreated through Crafting.

Unique magical abilities, lost data, sapient personalities, singular materials, and effects whose source no longer exists require appropriate surviving components or an adventure to recover what is missing.

MUSEUM QUALITY

FEAT 16

ARCHETYPE

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

Your best restorations have become examples other specialists study.

During your daily preparations, designate one nostalgic-modified archaic weapon or suit of armor you own.

That item gains one additional upgrade slot until your next daily preparations.

An upgrade installed in this additional slot remains physically installed if the item stops being designated, but the upgrade becomes inactive until the item has a free upgrade slot or becomes your Museum Quality item again.

OLD MAGIC, OLD STEEL

FEAT 16

ARCHETYPE

Prerequisites Runic Preservation

You can integrate surviving enchantments without sacrificing the improvements that keep an ancient item competitive.

During your daily preparations, designate one nostalgic-modified archaic item containing at least one property rune.

One property rune on that item doesn't occupy an upgrade slot.

Only one property rune can benefit from Old Magic, Old Steel at a time.

PROVEN DESIGN

FEAT 18

ARCHETYPE FORTUNE

Prerequisites Nostalgic Dedication

Frequency once per 10 minutes

Trigger You fail, but don't critically fail, a Strike with a nostalgic-modified archaic weapon.

You've used the weapon long enough to know exactly how to correct a bad attack.

Reroll the triggering attack roll and use the new result.

USING THE ARCHETYPE

A Nostalgic's interests can come from almost any part of history.

A character might restore pre-PES machinery, study a culture destroyed during the early intersystem era, practice an ancestral martial tradition, collect obsolete consumer electronics, reproduce historical music, maintain ancient religious observances, cook extinct regional cuisines, or carry weapons that most people encounter only in museums.

An item's age doesn't determine whether it has the archaic trait. A newly manufactured weapon built according to an archaic design can still be archaic. Black-powder firearms, bows, traditional blades, and similar equipment continue to be produced by specialists and enthusiasts.

Likewise, an old item isn't automatically archaic if it was built using technology comparable to modern Settled Systems equipment.

NOSTALGIC CHARACTERS IN THE SETTLED SYSTEMS

The Settled Systems contain enormous archives of preserved information, though access to the original objects and traditions represented in those archives varies considerably. Museums, universities, private collectors, ancestry communities, religious organizations, isolated settlements, historical societies, and commercial

manufacturers all preserve different pieces of the past.

Erbium Industries also maintains substantial historical collections. Corporate archives tend to value provenance, ownership documentation, technical relevance, and intellectual-property status alongside historical importance.

Some Nostalgics make a living restoring museum pieces or authenticating collections. Others reproduce archaic equipment commercially or practice traditions maintained within their families and communities.

There is no requirement that a Nostalgic consider the past better than the present. Their defining skill is knowing how to make the past work.